

Managing Your Emotions

Your emotions aren't your enemies

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Your emotions aren't your enemies

Anger, sadness, fear, shame... When emotions overflow, we have two reflexes: stifle them (and they come out sideways) or get swept away. Yet an emotion isn't a problem: it's a message. Learning to welcome and regulate it changes everything.

This guide helps you understand your emotions, ease the ones that overflow, and live them without being run by them.

Your intention

An emotion that often overwhelms you: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What your emotions are saying

The emotions we learned to silence as children (forbidden anger, sadness 'we had to hide') come back in disguise. Understanding your relationship to emotions — which you allow, which you flee — sheds light on many of your reactions.

Naming an emotion already gives you some power over it.

Example

Raised to 'not complain', Maya turned her sadness into irritability. Finally naming it soothed her.

Exercise — My emotional map

Which emotions do I allow? Which do I flee or judge? Where does it come from?

The emotion's message

For a recent strong emotion, write: what was it trying to tell me? what need is behind it?

→ *My emotions are messengers, not enemies.*

Thoughts and emotions

It isn't events that create emotion, but what we tell ourselves about them. Same situation + catastrophe thought = anxiety; + a balanced thought = calm. Spotting the thought behind the emotion lets you regulate it.

You don't have to believe every thought.

Example

Instead of 'this is a disaster', Léo told himself 'it's unpleasant but manageable'. The anxiety came down.

The situation–thought–emotion triangle

For a recent overflow: the situation · the thought · the emotion · a fairer thought.

Defuse

When emotion rises, name it ('this is fear'). Naming = already regulating.

→ *Between the event and the emotion is my thought — and I can act on it.*

Welcoming without judging

Regulating doesn't mean repressing. The humanistic lens invites you to welcome the emotion kindly: feel it, let it pass (emotions are waves), without judging yourself for being afraid, sad or angry.

What we resist persists; what we welcome eases.

Example

Rather than fighting her sadness, Sofia allowed herself to feel it for 10 minutes. It passed faster than expected.

Exercise — The wave

With the next strong emotion, watch it like a wave: where do I feel it in the body? it rises, peaks, recedes.

Self-compassion

A line to tell yourself when an emotion hurts: e.g. 'This is hard right now, and it's ok to feel this.'

→ *Welcomed without judgment, an emotion passes. Repressed, it insists.*

Regulating day to day

Regulation also plays out in the body and environment: breathing, movement, sleep, limiting what triggers you. Concrete tools calm the nervous system when emotion overflows.

Your body is a powerful ally for regulating your emotions.

Example

When anger rose, Karim got into the habit of breathing slowly for a minute before replying. His reactions changed.

Exercise — My emotional first-aid kit

Note 3 moves that calm you quickly (breathe, walk, cold water, call someone).

My triggers

List 2-3 recurring triggers + a way to reduce their impact.

→ *My body is an ally: breathing, moving, slowing down regulates emotion.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Name the emotion under your breath ('this is anger'): naming already soothes.
- 4-6 breathing: inhale 4 sec, exhale 6 sec, a few times — it calms the nervous system.
- Emotions are waves: they peak then recede. Wait for the dip before acting.
- Don't decide while hot: 'I'll get back to you in an hour'.
- Move: 10 min of walking lowers the emotional load.
- Ask the emotion: 'what do you need?' (rest, a limit, comfort).

To fill in

My emotion journal

Day	The situation	The emotion	A fairer thought

My first-aid kit

The emotion	The move that soothes me

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Recognize and name my emotions.

Week 2 — See the thought behind the emotion.

Week 3 — Welcome without judging.

Week 4 — Regulate day to day (body, breaks).

Your plan in 3 lines

- The emotion I'm working on:
- The thought I reframe:
- My soothing move:

TO CLOSE

Befriended, your emotions become guides.

Without judging yourself. You welcome, you breathe, you regulate.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.